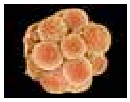
Bixby in more countries
Sansung's voice assistant is now accessible in more than 200 countries. Third-party applications coming soon. **http://dgit.in/200Bixby**



Genetically modified humans
Scientists confirm wide circulating reports that they have successfully genetically modified human embryos. **http://dgit.in/GenHuman**

remained so high that these things are relegated to trade shows and showroom exhibits. What seems to be the game-changer is Microsoft's range of Mixed-Reality headsets which are slated to be launched towards December this year. And Microsoft has done the right thing by partnering with Acer, ASUS, Dell, HP and Lenovo so that each manufacturer can build a mixed reality headset of their own. Basically, Microsoft built a technology, licensed it out to multiple brands and thereby is building an ecosystem with competition inherently built in. The effects of which were noticed when Acer was the first to announce their Mixed Reality headset for a mere $299.

Sony PlayStation VR

Compare that to the Rift and Vive's $699 and $799 launch prices and we see what could be a winner.

The PC space is one half of the VR phenomenon, it's the better experience but one that it matched with an equally bigger price tag. Mobiles on the other hand hold a significant advantage. They're seen as a necessity these days. Though a phone capable of VR is certainly seen as a luxury. The key players in the mobile segment are the Samsung Gear VR and the Google Daydream. Both, really big companies

Samsung Gear VR

with VR headsets that are way affordable than the PC market. However, the affordability isn't because Samsung and Google were struck by the philanthropy bug, it's because these are using more power efficient tech that don't hold enough horsepower. Since mobile VR is the more economical alternative, it stands to reason that if at all VR is going to catch up and become mainstream, it should be these mobile VR headsets that lead the revolution. The latest statistics, however, aren't that encouraging. In a recent study by Newzoo, it was revealed that of the 2.8 billion smartphones out there, only 0.2% are even capable of running Google DayDream and 6.6% are capable of running Samsung Gear VR. That's a total of 191.1 million devices globally that are VR ready. And to make things appear even more bleak, not all who get these VR ready devices do so with the intention of buying a DayDream or Gear VR. *sigh*

So while the PC market has Microsoft to look forward to, as the one brand that will finally democratise VR, the smartphone market still looks bleak. India being one of the largest, if not the largest, smartphone markets in the world still sees the greatest demand for budget smartphones. I know that because of the overwhelming amount of Internet traffic that we get for articles through such non-VR-ready devices. So I still have hopes that the PC market will be the first to adopt greater numbers of VR headsets post this December but the mobile market is still waiting for that one brand to come forth and lead the charge. A brand which would offer flagship level hardware without a massive price premium. Someone like the original OnePlus, not its current me-too avatar. Or it could even arise

Google Daydream

from the SoC manufacturers should they offer their flagship SnapDragons or MediaTeks for low prices, just to get the VR market the push that it needs. Till then, I don't think the smartphone market will adopt VR the way it should have already.

BUYING ADVICE

ROUTER DROPS CONNECTIONS

Q Hello, I recently bought an N150 router on sale from Amazon for really cheap. I've set it all up and there is one problem. It only allows four devices to be connected at any time. The moment I try connecting the 5th device, one of the other connected devices are dropped? Is the router faulty? My older router which was provided by the ISP could easily handle more devices and is some unknown brand. What should I do?

–Aamir S.

A Hey Aamir, the reason your older and cheaper router can handle more clients than your newer router is because of the firmware. Routers these days have firmware based limitations as to the number of clients it can handle. This is why despite having sufficient hardware to handle more clients, it refuses to do so or starts dropping older connections. Now your choice is to flash a custom firmware on a compatible router to remove this limitation or buy a more expensive router which can handle more clients. The issue here is that custom firmware are mostly compatible with Atheros or Ralink based routers which aren't exactly economical either. So, it's